

Interaction unlimited

‘Beauty is in the eye of the beholder’ and ‘the first impression is the last impression’ are two popular adages that need no introduction to be honest. We’ve all heard them umpteenth times. However, this month’s FastTrack topic has a lot to do with both the above expressions. Allow us to explain...

From the dawn of basic intelligence, it has not always been the fastest, highest or strongest that has prevailed – especially in the world of technology. Many a times it has been the best designed or best presented. One of the reasons why the world adores and swears by Apple products is their attention to unflinching detail when it comes to designing products and systems that just work effortlessly and intuitively without forcing their users to scratch their heads in frustration. And the essence of this we experience in a myriad things we do on a daily basis, unbeknownst to us – from interacting with the television, computer, ATM machine, smartphone, reading a train time table or even going through a candidate’s CV. In the non-analogue world, if there exists a digital system that’s for mass consumption, chances are that it’ll have something unique that differentiates itself from its competitors – the User Interface. Having said that what’s most important about designing interfaces for human interaction? It has to be more than aesthetically appealing, it has to be more than functional, and it has to be more than intuitive to create the best first impression. This is where User Experience or UX comes into the picture.

Confusing? That’s why the need for this booklet.

In here, we start off with a much needed introduction to UX design concepts (form vs function and all that jazz), moving on to breaking down the design process into various stages, including how to design an interface